



services by stalling simple approvals. The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) had also asked the EPFO to prioritise the upgrade of its IT infrastructure.

However, since late 2024, the Ministry of Labour and Employment and the EPFO seem to have gone on a mission mode to address these issues and improve customer service to make the organisation future-ready, in sync with the government's plan to include informal sector employees, such as gig and platform workers, within its ambit.

The two focus areas include improving services by simplifying processes and upgrading the IT software. The idea is to reduce the time for settlement of auto claims to one day. Union Labour and Employment Minister Mansukh Mandaviya has been holding regular meetings to review the progress of the reforms being undertaken. The labour minister has underlined that EPFO beneficiaries will be able to withdraw funds from ATMs due to faster processing of claims. "The EPFO will soon implement a Version 3.0 (of the system) with the help of a robust IT platform to provide seamless and simplified services, including auto-claim settlements, digital corrections, and ATM-based fund withdrawals. The overhaul is aimed at making the EPFO accessible and efficient," he has said.

The change is visible. Puneet Gupta, Tax Partner, EY India, says the EPFO is trying to reform its systems by cutting down on unnecessary approvals and compliances. "The systems are being made more efficient and settlements faster. This is a welcome move," he says.

CUTTING DOWN COMPLIANCES

The simplification of processes has involved changes such as doing away with the need for the employer's approval in most joint declaration requests. EPF members whose Universal Account Number (UAN) has been validated through Aadhaar can now change personal details such as name and date of birth online without verification by the employer or approval by the EPFO. This is expected to have eliminated an average delay of nearly 28 days taken by the employer to approve such requests. Requests for transfer of PF accounts earlier also required the employer's approval. The EPFO has removed the need for approval of all transfer claims at the Destination Office by launching a revamped Form 13 software functionality. But these facilities are available only to subscribers whose UAN

THE DASHBOARD

- The EPFO is the country's second-largest financial organisation after LIC
- The number of subscribers and corpus under management have made it difficult to manage operations

796,093

CONTRIBUTING
ESTABLISHMENTS

77,685,014

CONTRIBUTING
MEMBERS

77,293,483

KYC
STATUS

8,163,321

PENSIONERS

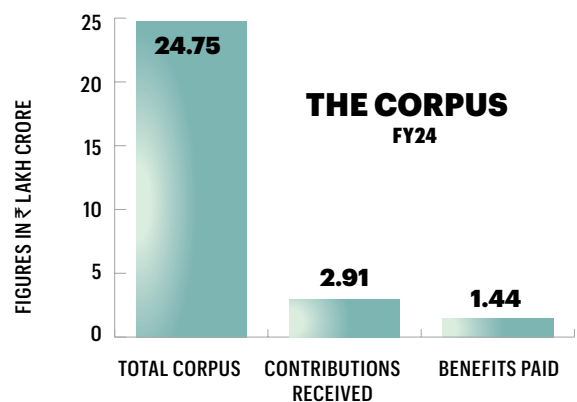
60,979,518

CLAIMS SETTLED

FOR PAST ONE YEAR

SOURCE EPFO LIVE DASHBOARD

57



SOURCE EPFO ANNUAL REPORT 2023-24